



National  
Qualifications  
2023

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## **2023 Music Technology**

### **Higher**

## **Finalised Marking Instructions**

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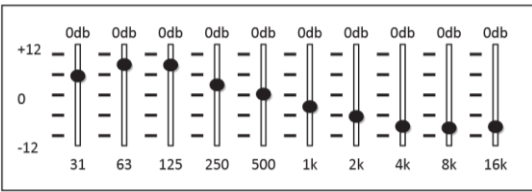
## General marking principles for Higher Music Technology

*Always apply these general principles. Use them in conjunction with the detailed marking instructions, which identify the key features required in candidates' responses.*

- (a) Marks for each candidate response must always be assigned in line with these general marking principles and the detailed marking instructions for this assessment.
- (b) Do not accept any answer that is not in the marking instructions. Use professional judgement when candidates' responses do not exactly match marking instructions but carry the same meaning.
- (c) Where a question asks for a description, explanation or justification, do not award marks for simple one or two word answers.
- (d) Accept inaccurate spelling of English or Italian terms, as long as the meaning is clear.

## Marking instructions for each question

| Question |     |      | Expected response                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Max mark | Additional guidance                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|----------|-----|------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1.       | (a) |      | Harmonics<br>Indie                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | 2        | 1 mark for each.<br>Do not accept other answers here.                                                                                                                                                                     |
|          | (b) |      | Chorus on electric guitar<br>Driving rhythm section<br>Electric guitar is the main harmonic instrument<br>Live sounding recording<br>(Lead and/or rhythm) electric guitar<br>Ostinato <b>or</b> riff<br>Reverb on electric guitar<br>Unpolished vocals.                                      | 2        | 1 mark for each correct answer.<br><br>Electric guitar on its own is acceptable.<br>Also accept lo-fi recording<br><br>Do not accept reverb on its own.<br>Also accept anything that infers a raw sounding vocal.         |
| 2.       | (a) |      | Electroacoustic<br><br>Sounds created and/or processed by electronic means<br>Tape manipulation<br>Time compression<br>Time expansion<br>Use of delay<br>Use of fade in/out<br>Use of loops<br>Use of multi-tracking<br>Use of panning<br>Use of pitch bend or pitch shift<br>Use of reverb. | 3        | 1 mark for correct genre.<br><br>2 marks for a reason related to a technological concept.<br>Also accept sound being reversed.<br>Also accept synthesiser.<br><br>(Accept any inference to the extensive use of effects). |
|          | (b) |      | Vocoder                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | 1        | Do not accept other answers here.                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| 3.       | (a) | (i)  | Poorly balanced mix.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | 1        | Accept any inference to the poor balance of parts.                                                                                                                                                                        |
|          |     | (ii) | Balance the audio correctly.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | 1        | Accept any inference to the correction of the mix balance.                                                                                                                                                                |
|          | (b) | (i)  | (The MIDI kick drum track is) out of time.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | 1        | Accept bass drum track is out of time.<br>Accept quantise value set incorrectly.<br>Do not accept (MIDI drums are) out of sync.                                                                                           |
|          |     | (ii) | Quantise the (MIDI) kick drum track (to the correct value).                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | 1        | Accept re-record in time <b>or</b> re-program in time                                                                                                                                                                     |

| Question |     | Expected response                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | Max mark | Additional guidance                                                                                           |
|----------|-----|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 4.       | (a) | EQ 2<br><br>Justification - Bass frequencies are boosted.                                                                                                                                                                        | 1        | Do not accept other answers here.                                                                             |
|          | (b) | Flanger                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | 1        | Accept phaser.                                                                                                |
| 5.       | (a) | Portamento<br>Wah-wah                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | 2        | Do not accept other answers here.                                                                             |
|          | (b) | A matched pair of cardioid condensers in XY/ORTF.<br><b>OR</b><br>Stereo pair of omni-directional condensers in AB/spaced pair.<br>Microphones should be placed at least a metre from the source.<br>This will ensure a good balance of direct sound and ambience.<br><b>OR</b><br>To ensure a good stereo image. | 3        | 1 mark for microphone array.<br><br><br>1 mark for placement.<br><br>1 mark for justification.                |
|          | (c) | Chromatic                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | 1        | Do not accept other answers here.                                                                             |
| 6.       |     | 1. High pass                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | 1        | Do not accept other answers here.                                                                             |
|          |     | 2. Tremolo<br>Flanger                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | 2        | Also accept delay.<br>Also accept phaser.<br>Do not award 2 marks for flanger and phaser.                     |
|          |     | 3. Threshold                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | 1        | Do not accept other answers here.                                                                             |
|          |     | 4. Feedback                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | 1        | Also accept mix or wet or dry.                                                                                |
|          |     | 5. Harmoniser                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | 1        | Do not accept other answers here.                                                                             |
|          |     | 6. Homophonic                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | 1        | Do not accept other answers here.                                                                             |
| 7.       |     | Acoustic guitar plays fingerpicked riff<br>Soprano vocal with hall reverb<br>Arco strings<br>Rolls played on marimba<br>Cymbal rolls and single hits                                                                                                                                                              | 5        | 1 mark for each correct feature.<br>Features can be listed in any order.<br>Do not accept other answers here. |

[END OF MARKING INSTRUCTIONS]